

PM Planning with Adam (05/18/2026)

News for Today

- 3-Month Bill Auction Previous (3.610%) (11:30AM)
 - 6-Month Bill Auction Previous (3.610%) (11:30AM)
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Market Overview — Monday, May 18th, 2026

U.S. Futures Slide as Bond Yields and Oil Prices Pressure Markets

U.S. stock futures are lower Monday morning as rising Treasury yields and elevated oil prices continue to weigh on sentiment amid few signs of a near-term resolution to the Iran conflict.

- Dow futures: -321 pts (-0.7%)
- S&P 500 futures: -0.4%
- Nasdaq futures: -0.3%

Markets are coming off a weak Friday session where all three major indexes fell more than 1%.

Bond market becomes the dominant concern

Rising bond yields are now becoming one of the market's biggest macro headwinds.

- U.S. 10-year yield = highest level in 15 months
- 30-year yields also climbing sharply

Higher yields are increasing pressure on:

- Stock valuations
- Borrowing costs
- Consumer spending
- Corporate financing

👉 Key concern:

Persistent inflation from higher oil prices could force central banks to stay tighter for longer.

Oil climbs back above \$110

Oil prices continue pushing higher as the Iran conflict drags into its 80th day with little progress toward a full resolution.

- Brent crude: ~\$110

Weekend developments increased tensions further:

- Drone strike hit a UAE nuclear facility
- Saudi Arabia intercepted drones
- Strait of Hormuz remains heavily disrupted

👉 Impact:

- Inflation fears intensifying
 - Gasoline prices rising again
 - Risk sentiment weakening
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Fragile ceasefire remains in place

Despite continued military activity, markets are still watching a fragile ceasefire between Washington and Tehran.

President Donald Trump stated that “the clock is ticking” for Iran to agree to a deal, while also saying Tehran is eager to sign an agreement.

Analysts increasingly believe the U.S. may want to avoid restarting major combat due to:

- Political pressure
- Economic consequences
- Rising inflation ahead of elections

Current setup:

- Stalemate continues
 - Markets remain highly headline-sensitive
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AI enthusiasm still limiting downside

Even with macro pressure building, AI optimism continues helping support equities overall.

Markets are now turning attention toward upcoming earnings from:

- Nvidia 🔥

The report is expected to be one of the biggest tests yet for the sustainability of the AI-driven rally.

Samsung gains after government intervention

- Samsung Electronics: higher after South Korea's government stepped in to help prevent a strike at the company's memory chip operations

The strike threat had raised concerns over potential disruption to global AI chip supply chains.

China growth data disappoints

Fresh economic data out of China showed slowing momentum:

- Industrial production missed expectations
- Retail sales growth came in extremely weak

👉 Suggests:

- Domestic demand remains soft
 - Property market weakness continues weighing on growth
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⚠ Breakdown: what's driving the market now?

- Rising Treasury yields
- Oil back above \$110
- Iran conflict unresolved
- AI still providing support
- China growth slowing

👉 Market = risk-off tone with AI preventing deeper selloff

👁 What traders are watching today

- Treasury yield movement
 - Oil price action
 - Iran ceasefire headlines
 - Nvidia earnings later this week
 - China economic weakness
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🔍 Adam's Watchlist

- \$QQQ: Looking to go long off the 712's KL for a push up into the 715.10's KL and potentially the 717's/720's KL. If we break below, I'll be going short off the 709's KL for a push down into the 706's KL and potentially the 704's/702's KL.

- \$XOM : Looking to go long off the 159.60's KL for a push up into the 162's KL and potentially the 164's KL.
- \$AMD: Looking to go long off the 431's KL for a push up into the 435.83's KL and potentially the 442.60's KL.
- \$INTC: Looking to go long off the 113.22's KL for a push up into the 116's KL and potentially the 120.50's KL.
- \$F: Looking to go long off the 14.30's KL for a push up into the 14.90's KL.
- \$FIG: Looking to go long off the 22.13's KL for a push up into the 24.22's KL.
- \$META: Looking to go long off the 613.20's KL for a push up into the 622.35's KL.
- \$NVDA: Looking to go long off the 231's KL for a push up into the 233's KL and potentially the 236.58's KL.

⚡ COMMUNITY WATCHLIST ⚡

- \$IREN: Looking to go long off the 55's KL for a push up into the 58.30's KL.
- \$BIDU: Looking to go long off the 143.44's KL for a push up into the 145.31's KL and potentially the 147's KL.

